ARTIST REFERENCE

Tattoo Contraindication Chart

A quick screen, not a diagnosis. When in doubt, don't start and ask for written medical clearance.

KEY **No** Don't tattoo **Wait** Postpone until resolved **Doctor OK** Clearance first *Caution* Modify OK Proceed

IF CLIENT HAS	Standard	Cover-up	Fine line	Large	Touch-up	Second-skin
SKIN & SITE						
Sunburn or fresh tan at site [1]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Rash, cut, flare or infection [2]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Mole or raised spot at site [3]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
Keloid or raised scar history [4]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
Laser session at the site [5]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Hands, feet or fingers [6]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK	*Caution*	*Caution*
HEALTH & MEDICINES						
Pregnant or breastfeeding [7]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Blood thinners or bleeding [8]	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**
Diabetes [9]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	**Doctor OK**	*Caution*	*Caution*
Immune suppression, chemo [10]	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**
Heart condition or pacemaker [11]	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**	**Doctor OK**
Epilepsy or fainting history [12]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
Accutane in last [6–12] months [13]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Latex or adhesive allergy [14]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	**No**
Past ink reaction [15]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*
SESSION & CONSENT						
Fever or feeling unwell [16]	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**	**Wait**
Alcohol or drugs in last 24 h [17]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Under 18 or no photo ID [18]	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**	**No**
Numbing product applied [19]	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*

[1] No tattooing burned or tanned skin. Wait until healed.
[2] Postpone until healed. Infection: see a doctor.
[3] Tattoo around it, never over, so it can be checked.
[4] Discuss the risk; small test spot first. Client initials.
[5] Wait until fully healed, about [6–8] weeks after laser.
[6] Fades and blurs faster; often no free touch-up.
[7] Postpone. Hold the design and deposit [policy].
[8] Bleeding disorders too. Never stop meds unadvised.
[9] Slower healing. Doctor OK for long sessions.
[10] Higher infection risk. Written doctor OK first.
[11] Doctor OK. Short sessions; know where meds are.
[12] Breaks, food and sugar on hand. Ask about their plan.
[13] Wait [6–12] months after the last dose.
[14] Nitrile gloves. No film; use plastic wrap or a pad.
[15] Avoid that color or brand; note the lot. Refer if unsure.
[16] Reschedule; no deposit penalty [policy].
[17] Refuse service. Deposit per policy.
[18] 18+ with photo ID. Minors only where law allows.
[19] Ask brand and amount. Max 4% lidocaine (FDA).

Conservative defaults; check your health department rules. Maker instructions and the client's doctor come first. Refer skin concerns to a doctor.